

Working as a volunteer in a charity shop – Unit 1

Teachers' notes**Overview**

'Working as a Volunteer in a Charity Shop' is aimed primarily at learners who are already working as volunteers in charity shops or who want to find out more about working in the sector. As the materials also look at interactions with customers and at how charity shops operate, they will also be useful for any learners who might visit charity shops; point out that charity shops tend to be welcoming (as well as cheap). The resource uses authentic sound recordings as a springboard for practice in all four skills within this context.

The resource is linked to 'Voluntary work', a resource which provides a minimum of three hours learning. Both resources were designed to complement each other and give learners a clear picture of working in this type of environment.

Note that the recordings were made *in situ* using a small, portable recording device to make sure the language was as authentic as possible. The quality may be 'grainy' in places, and there may be background noise.

Level: ESOL Entry 3 – Level 1 / SQA ESOL Intermediate 1 - Intermediate 2 in Scotland / B1 – B2 CEFR Framework

Learning hours and delivery context:

The resource provides a minimum of three hours of learning in a classroom or workplace context through a series of linked worksheets. Timings are flexible since learners can work through at their own pace and teachers can adapt the resource to suit their learners and build in revision as required. Online versions are available for most of the activities (in some cases, one worksheet covers two online activities).

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The activities are grouped into units as follows:

UNIT / TOPIC	WORKSHEETS and other materials	ONLINE (use this title to search)
Unit 1: Lead-in to the subject and pre-teaching of some key vocabulary.	1 Quiz/ vocabulary Powerpoint of pictures	Working in a charity shop, Unit 1, Activity 1 Working in a charity shop, Unit 1, Activity 2
Unit 2: Listening skills focussing on job roles in a charity shop. Can be delivered as a standalone unit.	2 Listening 1- What jobs do they do? 3 Listening 2- Eszter's jobs 4 Listening 3- Eszter's jobs gap-fill	Working in a charity shop, Unit 2, Activity 1 Working in a charity shop, Unit 2, Activity 2 Working in a charity shop, Unit 2, Activity 3
Unit 3: Follow-up writing practice.	5 Writing a note (harder version) 6 Writing a note (easier version) Worksheets 5 & 6 model answer	Working in a charity shop, Unit 3, Activity 1 Working in a charity shop, Unit 3, Activity 2 Working in a charity shop, Unit 3, Activity 3
Unit 4: Listening skills and language analysis focussing on customer interactions. Can also be delivered as a stand-alone unit.	7 Listening 4- Talking to a customer 8 Listening 5- Talking to a customer / Spot the error 9 Listening 6- Talking to a customer- listen for detail 10 Language focus	Working in a charity shop, Unit 4, Activity 1 Working in a charity shop, Unit 4, Activity 2 Working in a charity shop, Unit 4, Activity 3
Unit 5: Follow-up language analysis, reading and speaking activities.	11 What can a charity shop sell?(reading) 12 Role play	Working in a charity shop, Unit 5, Activity 1

The teachers' notes include suggestions on exploiting the materials, and teachers are encouraged to adapt them to meet group/individual needs. You can download worksheets, audio files, transcripts, and an answer key for each unit (where appropriate).

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Unit 1

Aims:

- To establish the context for learning.
- To stimulate discussion about charity shops.
- To help the teacher establish which learners have experience of the area.
- To pre-teach key vocabulary.

Objectives:

All learners will be able to:

- Talk about their own experience of charity shops as a volunteer, customer or donor.
- Explain how the sector operates.
- Read, pronounce and hear key vocabulary.

Some learners will be able to:

- Discuss in more detail how charity shops operate, the kinds of goods they sell, etc.

Materials: **Worksheet 1**

Approximate timing: 30 minutes

Suggested procedure:

Lead-in:

Use the visual 'Donations wanted' to introduce the topic; elicit from learners where they would see this sign. You might also want to draw their attention to the unusual dotted capital 'I' in 'DONATIONS'.

The following questions could form a whole-class or group discussion:

- Do you work in a charity shop?
- Do you know anyone who works in a charity shop?
- What charity shops are there in your area?
- What kind of things do they sell in charity shops?
- Do you ever buy things from a charity shop?
- Do you ever donate things to a charity shop?

You might want to brainstorm a list of charity shops and look at what the aims of each charity are.

If there are learners in the class who are currently working in a charity shop, ask these questions, which should produce some useful vocabulary and prepare the class for the activities that follow:

- What do you talk to customers about?
- What do you talk to colleagues about?

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Quick quiz:

If possible, put learners into groups in which at least one learner has experience of working in a charity shop. Don't spend too long on this. It might be useful to elicit 'volunteer' before you start.

If they have access to computers, learners should go to the online activity in unit 1 and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version: **Worksheet 1**

Vocabulary:

This part of the worksheet can be done in pairs or groups. Alternatively you could cut up the matching task and use it for a mingle activity.

Note that the vocabulary here comes up repeatedly in the recordings and in the follow-up activities, so once the task is finished the pronunciation should be drilled thoroughly. Try drilling the words in context rather than in isolation; you will find examples in the tapescripts

If they have access to computers, learners should go to the online activity in unit 1 and follow the instructions online. Alternatively hand out the paper version: **Worksheet 1**